

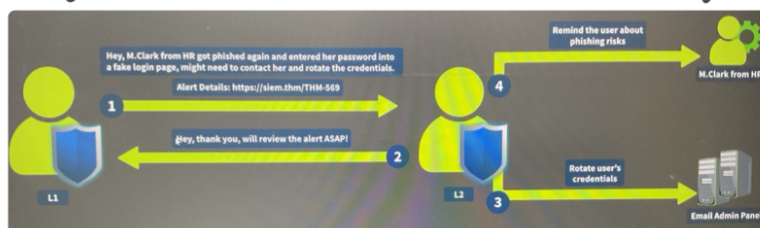
Task 4 :- Escalation Guide

After you made a verdict and written your alert report, you must choose whether to escalate the alert to L2. Again, the answer may differ from team to team, but the following recommendations would generally fit most SOC teams. You should escalate the alerts if :-

1. The alert is an indicator of major cyberattacks requiring deeper investigation or DFIR.
2. Remediation actions like malware removal, host isolation, or password reset are required.
3. Communication with customers, partners, management, or law enforcement agencies is required.
4. You just do not fully understand the alert and need some help from more senior analysts.

Escalation Steps :-

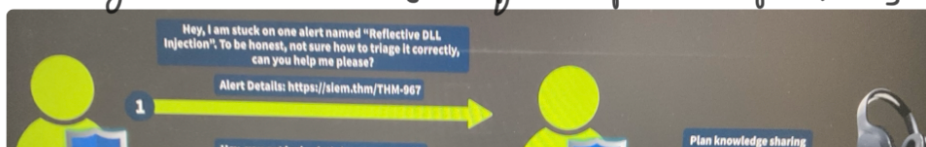
To escalate the alert, in most cases, all you have to do is reassign the alert to L2 on shift and ping them in corporate chat or in person. In some teams though, you may be required to create a formal written escalation request with dozens of required fields.



No matter what agreements are, L2 will eventually receive ticket from you, and report, and contact you in case of any questions. Once everything is clear L2 analyst will typically research the alert details further, validate if alert is indeed **True positive**, communicate with other departments if needed, and for major incidents, starts a formal incident response process.

Requesting L2 Support :-

It's generally fine for L1 to request senior support if something is unclear. Especially in your first months, it's always better to discuss the alert and clarify SOC procedures than to blindly close the alert you don't understand yourself. The procedure for requesting support may differ, but how looks like:





SOC Dashboard Escalation :-

1. Move the alert **In progress** status and do the analysis
2. Write an alert report and set your **Verdict** such as True positive
3. If escalation is required, assign the alert to your **L2 on Shift**.
4. L2 will receive notification and start from your alert report.

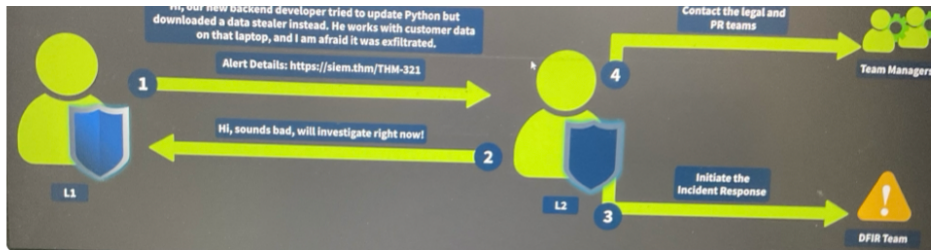
Task 5:- SOC Communication.

The Escalation and reporting topics should sound straightforward and logical to you. But as always it's easier said than done. And you should be prepared for unexpected scenarios and know what to do in critical cases. In best scenario SOC team has its own **crisis communication procedures** - The guides and processes to help you and your teammates resolve the issues. If not, you are advised to read the cases below and be prepared to handle them efficiently.

Communication Cases :-

- * You need to escalate an urgent, critical alert but L2 is unavailable and does respond for 30 minutes:-
Ensure you know where to find emergency contacts. First try to call L2, then L3, and finally your manager.
- * The alert about Slack / Teams account compromise requires you to validate the login with affected user:-
Do not contact the user to breached chat - use alternative contact methods like phone call.
- * You receive an overwhelming number of alerts during short period of time, some of which are critical:-
prioritize the alerts according to workflow, but inform your L2 on shift about the situation.
- * After a few days, you realize that you misclassified the alert and likely missed a malicious action.
Immediately reach out to your L2 explaining your concerns. Threat actors can be silent for weeks before impact.
- * You can not complete the alert triage since SIEM logs are not parsed correctly or are not searchable:-
Do not skip the alert - Investigate what you can and report the issue to your L2 on shift or SOC Engineer.

Communication By L2:-



Quiz:-

1) Should you first try to contact your manager in case of critical threat (yea/Nay)?

A) Nay

2) Should you immediately contact your L2 if you think you missed the attack (yea/Nay)?

A) yea